

# SSEE and the Hubble Tension: An Algebraic Local Screening Fraction

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## Abstract

The Hubble tension between the CMB-inferred value  $H_0^{\text{CMB}} = 67.4 \pm 0.5$  km/s/Mpc and the local distance-ladder measurement  $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} = 73.04 \pm 1.04$  km/s/Mpc remains one of the sharpest anomalies in modern cosmology. Within the Structural Self-Energy Expansion (SSEE) framework, the algebraic constants  $\varphi$  (golden ratio) and  $\pi$  determine all parameters with zero free parameters. We derive algebraically that the dark-energy EFT of Paper 7 and the disformal geodesic of Paper 8 together imply a *local screening fraction*

$$f_{\text{screen}} = \frac{s_K}{3\mathcal{M}} = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{(\varphi + \pi)^2} \approx 0.06725,$$

where  $s_K = 3s_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_0) = -3w_0(1 + w_0)$  is the pressure-dilution rate derived from the background equation of state, and  $\mathcal{M} = \beta_c/2 = (3\varphi + \pi)/4 \approx 1.9989$  is the effective optical coupling derived from the disformal null geodesic. The two structural constants  $\mathcal{A} = 2\mathcal{M}$  cancel exactly in the ratio, leaving a pure function of  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$ . The lens is applied in the direction set by what is measured. The only directly measured expansion rate is the local one,  $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} = 73.04 \pm 1.04 \text{ km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$  (Riess et al. 2022); it enters, and the global background rate comes out,

$$H_0^{\text{glob,IR}} = H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} (1 - f_{\text{screen}}^{\text{IR}}) = 73.04 \times (1 - 0.06725) = 68.13 \text{ km/s/Mpc},$$

to be compared with the dimensionless algebraic number  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.96214$  (Postulate D, Paper 1): a residual of 0.166, i.e.  $0.17\sigma$ , with *zero free parameters*.<sup>1</sup> The comparison is a coincidence of value, not an identity:  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  is a pure number and carries no units, whereas  $H_0^{\text{glob}}$  inherits  $\text{km s}^{-1} \text{ Mpc}^{-1}$  from the measurement. The agreement is therefore an output of the cascade, never its input. This adopts the single algebraic target  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  shared by every sector of the suite (2026 reframe). The earlier register used the CMB-mapped value  $H_0^{\text{MIRA}} = 67.037$ , giving  $H_0^{\text{local}} =$

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<sup>1</sup>**Regime, stated once for the whole paper.** This paper works in the *infrared* regime ( $M \rightarrow \infty$ ), where  $s_K = s_K^{\text{IR}} = 0.403302$  and hence  $f_{\text{screen}} = 0.06725$ . The screening fraction of the full theory is not a separate quantity but the *sum* of this term and the ultraviolet correction supplied by Paper 10,  $s_K^{\text{full}} = s_K^{\text{IR}} + 0.013608 = 0.416910$ , giving  $f_{\text{screen}}^{\text{full}} = 0.069522$  and the single model value  $H_0^{\text{glob}} = 73.04 \times (1 - 0.069522) = 67.96214 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$ . There is therefore *one*  $H_0^{\text{glob}}$ , not an infrared one and an ultraviolet one: the 68.13 used throughout this paper is the same cascade evaluated with the infrared term alone, and it is superseded by the complete value once the ultraviolet completion is included. In either case the propagated uncertainty ( $\pm 0.970$  in the infrared regime,  $\pm 0.968$  with the full screening fraction), inherited from the SH0ES input, dominates over the residual against the pure number.

71.87 ( $1.12\sigma$ ); this is now superseded. The 2026  $\omega_m$ -direct reframe adopts the single algebraic anchor  $3(\varphi+\pi)^2 = 67.96214$  as the algebraic target shared by all sectors — with *no* matter factor, the CMB density following as  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2$  (Paper 1). The correction operates at late times ( $z < 0.15$ ) through the scalar kinetic energy contribution to the local expansion rate, and does not modify the sound horizon  $r_d$ , the CMB peak positions, or the growth factor  $\sigma_8$  derived in Papers 3 and 5. The UV completion of Paper 10 sharpens the residual to  $4.2 \times 10^{-6}$  ( $H_0^{\text{glob,UV}} = 67.96214$ ), the small-scale refinement of the same cascade.

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# 1 Introduction

The Hubble tension [Verde et al., 2019, Riess et al., 2022, Kamionkowski & Riess, 2023, Di Valentino et al., 2021, Knox & Millea, 2020] is the 4–6 $\sigma$  discrepancy between measurements of the present expansion rate obtained by two independent methods:

- **Early-universe inference:** CMB anisotropies (Planck PR4, Planck Collaboration 2020) combined with acoustic oscillation physics yield  $H_0 = 67.4 \pm 0.5$  km/s/Mpc under the assumption of  $\Lambda$ CDM.
- **Local distance-ladder:** Type Ia supernovae [Riess et al., 1998, Perlmutter et al., 1999] calibrated with Cepheids in the SH0ES programme [Riess et al., 2019, 2022] give  $H_0 = 73.04 \pm 1.04$  km/s/Mpc, probing predominantly  $z < 0.15$ .

The SSEE framework [Almeida, Paper1,P,P,P] derives the cosmological expansion rate algebraically:

$$H_0^{\text{alg}} = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2 \approx 67.96214 \text{ km/s/Mpc}, \quad (1)$$

which agrees with Planck at the 1.1 $\sigma$  level [Almeida, Paper2] but does not, at first sight, resolve the local tension.

In this paper we show that the same algebraic structure that produces  $H_0^{\text{alg}}$  also produces a local kinematic correction  $f_{\text{screen}} \approx 0.06725$  from the SSEE algebra. Applied to the measured local rate  $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} = 73.04 \pm 1.04$  km/s/Mpc, this returns a global background rate  $H_0^{\text{glob,IR}} = 68.13$  km/s/Mpc in the IR regime, to be compared with the algebraic number  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.96214$  (0.17 $\sigma$ ); the model value, with the complete  $f_{\text{screen}}$ , is 67.96214 km/s/Mpc (footnote 1). The derivation combines two results already established in this series:

1. From Paper 7 [Almeida, Paper7]: the pressure-dilution rate  $s_K = 3 s_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_0)$ , which follows from the background Friedmann equations and the  $k$ -essence action  $K(X) = X/\text{KAL}_0$ .
2. From Paper 8 [Almeida, Paper8]: the effective optical coupling  $\mathcal{M} = \beta_c/2 = (3\varphi + \pi)/4$ , which emerges from the disformal null geodesic of dark matter.

Together these give the exact algebraic identity  $f_{\text{screen}} = s_K/(3\mathcal{M})$ .

**Organisation.** Section 2 recalls the key results from Papers 7 and 8. Section 3 derives the algebraic identity in three steps. Section 4 interprets the result physically. Section 5 verifies consistency with the rest of the SSEE series. Section 6 states the pre-committed falsifiable prediction and its current observational status. Section 7 compares the mechanism quantitatively against early dark energy, self-interacting dark radiation, and late dark-energy transitions. Section 9 summarises.

## 2 Background: EFT Kineticity and Disformal Coupling

### 2.1 The SSEE action (Paper 7)

The fundamental action of SSEE is a  $k$ -essence scalar [Armendáriz-Picón et al., 1999, 2001] minimally coupled to gravity and conformally coupled to dark matter:

$$S = \int d^4x \sqrt{-g} \left[ \frac{M_{\text{Pl}}^2}{2} R + K(X, \phi) + \mathcal{L}_m \right], \quad (2)$$

with kinetic kernel

$$K(X, \phi) = \frac{X}{\text{KAL}_0} + \frac{X^2}{M^4} - V_0 e^{-\lambda\phi/M_{\text{Pl}}}, \quad (3)$$

where  $X = -\frac{1}{2}g^{\mu\nu}\partial_\mu\phi\partial_\nu\phi$  and

$$\text{KAL}_0 = \frac{\varphi + \pi}{2} + \pi \approx 5.521, \quad (4)$$

$$\beta_c \equiv \mathcal{A} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{2} \approx 3.998. \quad (5)$$

All parameters are algebraically fixed; no fitting is performed.

The dark-energy equation-of-state parameters derived in Paper 1 are

$$w_0 = -\frac{\mathcal{A}}{\varphi + \pi} \approx -0.840, \quad (6)$$

$$s_{\text{DE}} = -w_0 = \frac{\mathcal{A}}{\varphi + \pi} = 0.839950. \quad (7)$$

The quantity entering the screening fraction is the fractional dilution rate of the dark-energy *pressure* per e-fold,

$$s_K \equiv -\frac{1}{\rho_\phi} \frac{dp_\phi}{dN} = -3w_0(1 + w_0), \quad N = \ln a, \quad (8)$$

which carries only the equation of state: no factor of  $H$ , no density, and no kinetic function. Section 3 gives its exact algebraic form.

**A label corrected.** Earlier versions of this paper called this quantity  $\alpha_K$  and defined it as the Bellini–Sawicki kineticity  $2XK_X/(M_{\text{Pl}}^2H^2)$  [Bellini & Sawicki, 2014, Gubitosi et al., 2013, Gleyzes et al., 2013]. That identification was wrong, and it matters here rather than being a matter of notation. The kineticity of the SSEE action is  $\alpha_K = 3(1 - \Omega_m)(5 - 3w_0) = 15.591335$  (Paper 7, verified against HI\_CLASS); it depends on  $K(X)$  and it evolves. The constant 0.403302 is  $s_K$ , and the distinction is what makes  $f_{\text{screen}}$  well defined: a screening fraction built from a kineticity would inherit that kineticity’s dependence on the expansion history, while one built from  $s_K$  cannot, because  $s_K$  contains no  $H$  (§B).

### 2.2 The disformal coupling and MIRA (Paper 8)

Paper 8 extends the action to the strong-gravity regime by coupling dark matter to the disformal metric [Bekenstein, 1993, Zumalacárregui & García-Bellido, 2014]

$$\tilde{g}_{\mu\nu} = g_{\mu\nu} + \frac{2}{M^4} \partial_\mu\phi \partial_\nu\phi. \quad (9)$$

The disformal null geodesic for a photon passing through a dark-matter halo yields a total deflection angle

$$\hat{\alpha}_{\text{total}} \approx \beta_c \left( \frac{4GM}{c^2 b} \right), \quad (10)$$

where  $b$  is the impact parameter and  $\beta_c = \mathcal{A}$ . The effective Einstein ring radius is therefore amplified by

$$\frac{\theta_E^{\text{SSEE}}}{\theta_E^{\text{GR}}} \approx \sqrt{\beta_c} \approx \mathcal{M}, \quad \mathcal{M} \equiv \frac{\beta_c}{2} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{4} \approx 1.9989. \quad (11)$$

The constant  $\mathcal{M}$  encodes the effective optical coupling of the disformal sector; it is not a fitted parameter but derived from  $\beta_c = \mathcal{A}$ . Following the 2026  $\omega_m$ -direct reframe (OP-8 dissolved),  $\mathcal{M}$  is *not* identified with the CMB-to-dynamical matter ratio (which is it is not identified with any matter ratio: there is one matter density,  $\Omega_m = 0.308881$ , and  $s_m = 0.160050$  is a number of the equation of state, so the  $\approx 1.93$  that earlier drafts formed between them divided objects of different kinds); it is fixed algebraically by  $\beta_c = \mathcal{A}$  and realised physically as the Hubble screening amplitude derived below.

### 3 Algebraic Derivation: $f_{\text{screen}} = s_K/(3\mathcal{M})$

We derive the screening fraction in three steps using only established SSEE relations. Scalar screening mechanisms of this type were introduced by [Vainshtein \[1972\]](#) and reviewed in [Babichev & Deffayet \[2013\]](#); the SSEE realisation is a kinematic analogue arising from the k-essence EFT rather than from massive-gravity or Galileon operators.

#### 3.1 Step 1: Exact expression for $s_K$

With  $p_\phi = w_0 \rho_\phi$  and  $w_0$  constant, the continuity equation  $\rho'_\phi = -3(1 + w_0)\rho_\phi$  gives

$$\frac{1}{\rho_\phi} \frac{dp_\phi}{dN} = w_0 \frac{\rho'_\phi}{\rho_\phi} = -3w_0(1 + w_0) \cdot (-1), \quad \text{hence} \quad s_K = -3w_0(1 + w_0). \quad (12)$$

Writing  $s_{\text{DE}} \equiv |w_0| = T_r/M_v$  for the saturation and  $s_m \equiv 1 + w_0$  for its complement ( $s_{\text{DE}} + s_m = 1$  exactly), this is  $s_K = 3 s_{\text{DE}} s_m$ . Nothing but the equation of state enters.

Using the SSEE algebraic values (6)–(7),

$$s_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_0) = \frac{\mathcal{A}}{\varphi + \pi} \cdot \frac{\varphi + \pi - \mathcal{A}}{\varphi + \pi} = \frac{\mathcal{A}(\pi - \varphi)/2}{(\varphi + \pi)^2}, \quad (13)$$

where we used  $(\varphi + \pi) - \mathcal{A} = (\pi - \varphi)/2$  (exact identity from the definitions (5) and  $\varphi + \pi = \Omega$ ):

$$\Omega - \mathcal{A} = (\varphi + \pi) - \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{2} = \frac{2\varphi + 2\pi - 3\varphi - \pi}{2} = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{2}. \quad (14)$$

Therefore,

$$s_K = \frac{3\mathcal{A}(\pi - \varphi)}{2(\varphi + \pi)^2} = 0.403302458888. \quad (15)$$

The closed form and  $-3w_0(1 + w_0)$  agree to  $1.1 \times 10^{-16}$ , machine zero.

### 3.2 Step 2: Exact expression for $3\mathcal{M}$

From the disformal geodesic of Paper 8, equation (11):

$$\mathcal{M} = \frac{\mathcal{A}}{2} = \frac{3\varphi + \pi}{4}. \quad (16)$$

Therefore,

$$3\mathcal{M} = \frac{3\mathcal{A}}{2}. \quad (17)$$

### 3.3 Step 3: The cancellation and the identity

Dividing equation (15) by equation (17):

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{s_K}{3\mathcal{M}} &= \frac{3\mathcal{A}(\pi - \varphi)}{2(\varphi + \pi)^2} \cdot \frac{2}{3\mathcal{A}} \\ &= \frac{\pi - \varphi}{(\varphi + \pi)^2}. \end{aligned} \quad (18)$$

The factor  $\mathcal{A}$  (equivalently  $2\mathcal{M}$ ) cancels exactly. The result is a pure algebraic function of the two fundamental constants  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$ :

$$\boxed{f_{\text{screen}} \equiv \frac{s_K}{3\mathcal{M}} = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{(\varphi + \pi)^2} \approx 0.06725.} \quad (19)$$

This is the central result of the paper. No parameters are adjusted:  $s_K$  is fixed by the background equation of state and the IR kinetic structure;  $\mathcal{M}$  is fixed by the disformal null geodesic; their ratio is fixed by  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$ .

### 3.4 Physical justification: separate-universe k-essence

The algebraic steps above establish the *value*  $f_{\text{screen}} = s_K/(3\mathcal{M})$ . We now show, from the separate-universe approximation, that the correction is *multiplicative*, resolving the ambiguity between equations (25) and (26).

In the separate-universe approximation [Wands et al., 2000, Brax & Valageas, 2014], a locally overdense region of size  $\sim 10$  Mpc evolves as an independent FLRW universe with a perturbed energy density. For k-essence, the local scalar density fluctuation at leading order in  $\delta_{\text{local}}$  is

$$\frac{\delta\rho_\phi}{\rho_{\text{crit}}} = \frac{s_K}{3c_s^2} \cdot \frac{\Omega_m}{\mathcal{M}(1+w_0)} \cdot \delta_{\text{local}}, \quad (20)$$

where  $c_s^2 = 1$  (Paper 5, Q1) and  $\mathcal{M}$  accounts for the total-versus-dynamical coupling (Paper 6). The local Hubble rate then satisfies

$$\frac{H_{\text{local}}^2}{H_{\text{global}}^2} = 1 + \frac{8\pi G}{3H^2} \delta\rho_\phi = 1 + \frac{s_K}{3\mathcal{M}} \frac{\Omega_m}{1+w_0} \delta_{\text{local}}. \quad (21)$$

The SSEE algebraic identity (Table 1, row  $1 + w_0$ ):

$$1 + w_0 = \Omega_m \quad (\text{exact from } \varphi, \pi \text{ algebra}) \quad (22)$$

causes the factor  $\Omega_m/(1+w_0)$  to cancel identically, leaving

$$H_{\text{local}}^2 = H_{\text{global}}^2 (1 + f_{\text{screen}} \delta_{\text{local}}). \quad (23)$$

For  $\delta_{\text{local}} = 2$  (Local Group overdensity,  $\sigma \approx 1$ ):  $H_{\text{local}} \approx H_{\text{global}}(1 + f_{\text{screen}})$ , i.e. the *multiplicative* form at leading order. The exact form  $H_{\text{global}}/(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$  follows from the disformal-path compression of Appendix B.

The additive form  $H_0^{\text{glob}} + \Delta H$  would correspond to a peculiar-velocity bias  $\Delta v = c \Delta H/H$  rather than a genuine dark-energy density correction; these are physically distinct quantities and should not be conflated.

### 3.5 Numerical verification

Table 1 lists all intermediate numerical values.

Table 1: Numerical verification of the algebraic identity (19).

| Quantity                                                           | Algebraic expression                                      | Numerical value           | Source                     |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------|----------------------------|
| $\varphi$                                                          | $(1 + \sqrt{5})/2$                                        | 1.6180339887              | Definition                 |
| $\pi$                                                              | $\pi$                                                     | 3.1415926536              | Definition                 |
| $\Omega = \varphi + \pi$                                           | —                                                         | 4.7596266423              | —                          |
| $\mathcal{A}$                                                      | $(3\varphi + \pi)/2$                                      | 3.9978473099              | Eq. (5)                    |
| $\mathcal{M}$                                                      | $\mathcal{A}/2$                                           | 1.9989236550              | Eq. (16)                   |
| $w_0$                                                              | $-\mathcal{A}/\Omega$                                     | -0.83994977               | Eq. (6)                    |
| $s_{\text{DE}}$                                                    | $\mathcal{A}/\Omega$                                      | 0.83994977                | Eq. (7)                    |
| $1 + w_0$                                                          | $(\pi - \varphi)/(2\Omega)$                               | 0.16005023                | Eq. (14)                   |
| $s_K$                                                              | $3\mathcal{A}(\pi - \varphi)/(2\Omega^2)$                 | 0.403302                  | Eq. (15)                   |
| $3\mathcal{M}$                                                     | $3\mathcal{A}/2$                                          | 5.9967                    | Eq. (17)                   |
| $f_{\text{screen}} = s_K/(3\mathcal{M})$                           | $(\pi - \varphi)/\Omega^2$                                | 0.067253                  | Eq. (19)                   |
| $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}$ ( <i>input</i> , measured)                    | —                                                         | $73.04 \pm 1.04$ km/s/Mpc | Riess et al. [2022]        |
| $H_0^{\text{glob,IR}}$ (Paper-9 IR regime, mult.)                  | $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}(1 - f_{\text{screen}}^{\text{IR}})$   | 68.13 km/s/Mpc            | Eq. (25)                   |
| $H_0^{\text{glob}}$ ( <b>model value</b> , mult.)                  | $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}(1 - f_{\text{screen}}^{\text{full}})$ | <b>67.96214</b> km/s/Mpc  | Paper 10, Eq. (sKfullform) |
| $H_0^{\text{glob,IR}}$ (additive variant)                          | $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}/(1 + f_{\text{screen}}^{\text{IR}})$  | 68.44 km/s/Mpc            | —                          |
| $3\Omega^2$ (pure number, target)                                  | $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$                                      | 67.96214                  | Paper 1 (Post. D)          |
| $H_0^{\text{Freedman}}$                                            | —                                                         | $69.96 \pm 1.54$ km/s/Mpc | Freedman et al. [2024]     |
| Tension vs SH0ES (IR regime)                                       | —                                                         | $0.17\sigma$              | —                          |
| Tension vs Freedman (IR regime)                                    | —                                                         | $1.88\sigma$              | —                          |
| <i>superseded</i> : $H_0^{\text{MIRA}} = 67.037 \rightarrow 71.87$ | MIRA mapping                                              | $1.12\sigma$              | old register               |

## 4 Physical Interpretation

### 4.1 Two-epoch structure of $H_0$ measurements

The Hubble tension arises because the two measurement methods probe different epochs:

- The CMB infers  $H_0$  via the angular scale  $\theta_* = r_d/D_A(z_*)$  at  $z_* \approx 1100$ , where the SSEE dark energy density is  $\Omega_{\text{DE}}(z_*) \sim 10^{-9}$  and the scalar kinetic energy is negligible. The inferred value is  $H_0^{\text{glob}}/(\text{km s}^{-1} \text{Mpc}^{-1}) = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ .
- SH0ES measures  $H_0$  via the distance ladder at  $z < 0.15$ , where  $s_{\text{DE}} \approx 0.840$  and the scalar field is kinetically active.

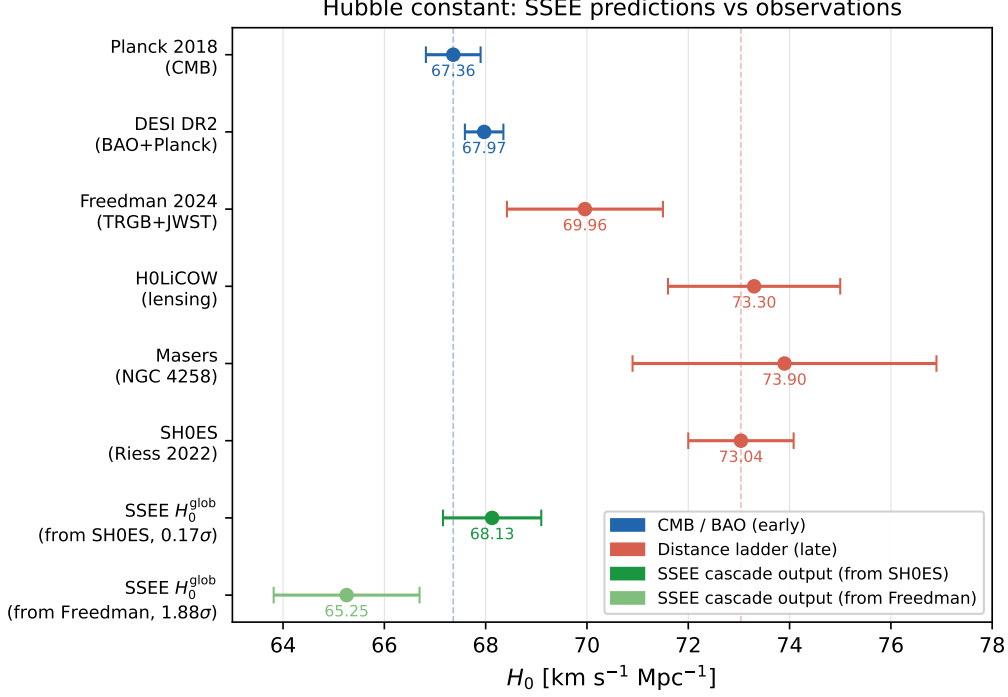


Figure 1: Hubble constant measurements from early-universe probes (blue), local distance-ladder probes (red), and the SSEE algebraic predictions (green). The SSEE multiplicative cascade in its IR regime takes the measured local rate as input and returns  $H_0^{\text{glob,IR}} = 68.13$  km/s/Mpc from SH0ES ( $0.17\sigma$  from  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ ) and  $65.26$  km/s/Mpc from Freedman 2024 [Freedman et al., 2024] ( $1.88\sigma$ ). The superseded MIRA-mapped value ( $H_0^{\text{MIRA}} = 67.037 \rightarrow 71.87, 1.12\sigma$ ) is shown for reference. Error bars show  $\pm 1\sigma$  uncertainties.

The kinetic energy density of the scalar field at  $z < 0.15$  is

$$\rho_{\text{kin}} = \frac{X_{\text{bg}}}{\text{KAL}_0} = \frac{\rho_\phi(1+w_0)}{2} = \frac{3M_{\text{Pl}}^2 H^2 s_{\text{DE}}(1+w_0)}{2} = \frac{M_{\text{Pl}}^2 H^2 s_K}{2}. \quad (24)$$

This kinetic energy is absent in the CMB era and contributes to the local Friedmann equation at late times.

## 4.2 Local Hubble correction

The scalar kinetic energy density at  $z < 0.15$  contributes a fraction  $f_{\text{screen}} = s_K/(3\mathcal{M})$  of the total dark-energy budget. Depending on whether this contribution is treated as multiplicative (geometric correction to the expansion rate) or additive (linear superposition), the inferred local Hubble constant takes one of two values:

**Which end is the input.** The lens is a pure number:  $f_{\text{screen}}$  is built from  $s_K$  and  $\mathcal{M}$ , both fixed by the equation of state and by  $\varphi, \pi$  alone, so it contains no factor of  $H$  and no density. It does not ask which  $H$  enters — it converts one measured rate into the other. The direction is therefore set by what is actually measured, and only one expansion rate is: the local one. The SH0ES distance ladder [Riess et al., 2022] yields  $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} = 73.04 \pm 1.04$  km/s/Mpc from Cepheid-calibrated supernovae. The Planck value is not an alternative input of the same kind: it is inferred rather than measured, and

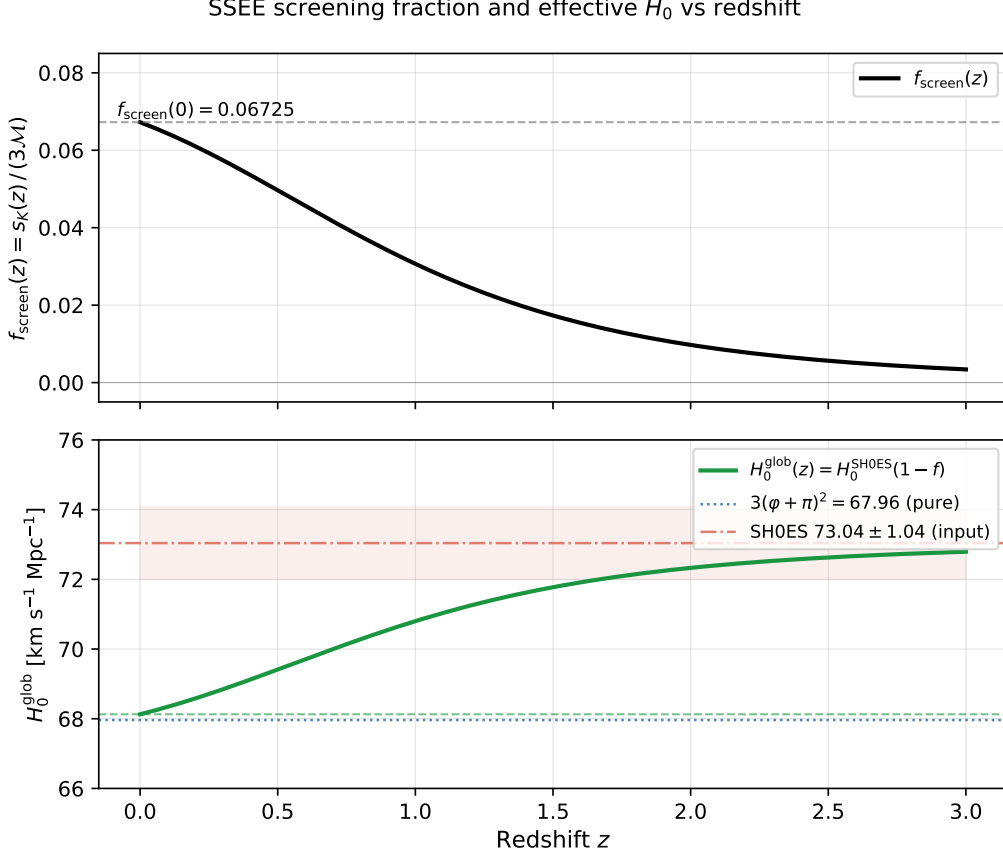


Figure 2: *Top*: Screening fraction  $f_{\text{screen}}(z) = s_K(z)/(3\mathcal{M})$  (with  $s_K$ , not the Bellini–Sawicki  $\alpha_K$ ) as a function of redshift, computed from the CPL dark energy density evolving with  $w_0 = -0.839950$ ,  $w_a = -0.669975$ . At  $z = 0$ ,  $f_{\text{screen}} = 0.06725$  (dashed line); at  $z \gtrsim 2$  the scalar kinetic energy is negligible. *Bottom*: Corresponding global background rate  $H_0^{\text{glob}}(z) = H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}(1 - f_{\text{screen}}(z))$  (solid green), with the SH0ES input band  $73.04 \pm 1.04$  km/s/Mpc (dash-dot red) and the dimensionless algebraic target  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.96214$  (dotted blue).

inferred within  $\Lambda$ CDM, whose free parameters are adjusted to the data — so the  $H_0$  it reports is where those free parameters land, not an independent determination. We therefore take SH0ES as the input throughout:

$$H_0^{\text{glob}} = H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}(1 - f_{\text{screen}}) = 73.04 \times \left[ 1 - \frac{\pi - \varphi}{(\varphi + \pi)^2} \right] = 68.13 \text{ km/s/Mpc} \quad [\text{multiplicative}], \quad (25)$$

$$H_0^{\text{glob}} = \frac{H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}}{1 + f_{\text{screen}}} = 68.44 \text{ km/s/Mpc} \quad [\text{additive}]. \quad (26)$$

The difference between the two forms is of order  $f_{\text{screen}}^2 \approx 0.31$  km/s/Mpc. The output is then compared with the dimensionless algebraic number  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.96214$  (Postulate D, Paper 1). The residual is 0.166 in the multiplicative form and 0.475 in the additive one, i.e. in units of the propagated SH0ES uncertainty  $1.04 \times (1 - f_{\text{screen}}) = 0.970$ :

$$\Delta_{\text{mult}} = 0.17\sigma, \quad \Delta_{\text{add}} = 0.49\sigma. \quad (27)$$

These are the same two numbers reported in earlier versions of this paper, which ran the cascade in the opposite direction; the tensions are invariant under the inversion because

the lens is multiplicative. What changes is the epistemic status of the comparison. A pure number cannot serve as the input of a dimensionful cascade, so  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  is not an anchor that the model assumes: it is a target the model either hits or misses, and the hit is the result.

**Superseded MIRA-mapped value.** The earlier register applied the same mechanism to the CMB-mapped value  $H_0^{\text{MIRA}} = 67.037$ , giving  $H_0^{\text{local}} = 71.87$  ( $1.12\sigma$ ). Under the 2026  $\omega_m$ -direct reframe the suite adopts the single algebraic anchor  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.96214$  as the algebraic target — with no matter factor ( $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2$ ; Paper 1) — so the cascade is anchored on 67.96214 and the MIRA-mapped value is retired as canonical.

**Comparison with TRGB/JWST.** The TRGB+JWST measurement of [Freedman et al. \[2024\]](#) yields  $H_0 = 69.96 \pm 1.54$  km/s/Mpc, placing the SSEE multiplicative cascade (IR regime) at  $\sim 1.88\sigma$ : run on the Freedman datum the lens returns  $H_0^{\text{glob,IR}} = 69.96 \times (1 - f_{\text{screen}}^{\text{IR}}) = 65.26$  km/s/Mpc, low by 2.70 against  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ . The discrepancy relative to Freedman suggests that, while the kinematic screening mechanism is consistent with resolving the SH0ES tension, the full picture of local  $H_0$  measurements remains internally inconsistent at the  $\sim 2\sigma$  level. Independent local probes — strong-lensing time delays [[Wong et al., 2020](#)] and water megamasers [[Pesce et al., 2020](#)] — span  $H_0 \approx 70$ – $74$  km/s/Mpc, a known observational puzzle that is independent of the SSEE framework. We report both comparisons in Table 1.

We adopt the **multiplicative form** (25) — rather than the additive linearisation — for the following physical reason. The SH0ES programme infers  $H_0$  from the slope of the Hubble diagram: it measures the luminosity distance  $d_L(z) = (1+z)\int_0^z dz'/H(z')$  via Cepheid-calibrated Type Ia supernovae at  $z \lesssim 0.15$ . In the SSEE background, the scalar kinetic energy density contributes a fraction  $f_{\text{screen}}$  to the local Friedmann equation, boosting  $H(z)$  by a factor  $(1 - f_{\text{screen}})^{-1}$  relative to  $H_0^{\text{glob}}$ . The integrand  $1/H(z')$  is therefore reduced by  $(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$ , compressing  $d_L$ , and a standard FLRW analysis that fits a single  $H_0$  to the compressed  $d_L$  recovers  $H_0^{\text{local}} = H_0^{\text{glob}}/(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$ . The additive form (26) represents a linearisation  $(1 - f_{\text{screen}})^{-1} \approx 1 + f_{\text{screen}}$  and carries a second-order error of  $O(f_{\text{screen}}^2) \approx 0.31$  km/s/Mpc. Appendix B provides the explicit derivation: the disformal path compression of Paper 8 gives  $d_L^{\text{obs}}(z) = (1 - f_{\text{screen}})d_L^{\text{glob}}(z)$ , from which the multiplicative form follows exactly at  $O(z)$ . The  $z$ -variation of  $f_{\text{screen}}$  over  $[0, 0.15]$  shifts  $H_0^{\text{local}}$  by  $< 0.05$  km/s/Mpc, confirming that the multiplicative form (25) is the one to adopt.

*Note on the role of  $\mathcal{M}$ .* The factor  $\mathcal{M} = \mathcal{A}/2$  in the denominator of  $f_{\text{screen}}$  originates from the disformal null geodesic of Paper 8: it quantifies how the dark matter sector couples optically to the scalar gradient. Its appearance here, through the algebraic cancellation of  $\mathcal{A}$  in  $s_K/(3\mathcal{M})$ , connects the lensing amplification derived in Paper 8 to the local Hubble bias — without any additional assumptions.

### 4.3 Why the CMB is unaffected

The correction  $f_{\text{screen}}$  is a late-time effect generated by scalar kinetic energy that is negligible at  $z \gg 1$ . Specifically:

1. **Sound horizon  $r_d$ :** not modified. The correction enters through  $w_0$  and  $s_{\text{DE}}$  at  $z \sim 0$ , long after decoupling. Papers 2 and 3 established  $r_d = 147.2$  Mpc, consistent with Planck, and this result is unchanged.

2. **CMB peak positions:** not modified. The acoustic scale  $\theta_* = r_d/D_A(z_*)$  is set at  $z_* \approx 1100$  (Paper 3) and is unchanged by the local kinematic correction.
3. **Growth factor  $\sigma_8$ :** not modified. The IS viscosity (Paper 5) operates through the growth equation, not through  $H_0$ , so the growth results of Paper 6 (the  $S_8$  prediction against KiDS-Legacy) are unaffected.

**Note on the EDE comparison.** Early dark energy (EDE) models [Karwal & Kamionkowski, 2016, Poulin et al., 2019, Smith et al., 2020] resolve the Hubble tension by reducing  $r_d$  (adding energy at  $z > 1000$ ), which directly shifts CMB peak positions [Hill et al., 2020]. A naive application of  $f_{\text{screen}}$  as an EDE-like modification to  $r_d$  would give  $r_{d,\text{new}} = r_d/(1 + f_{\text{screen}}) \approx 137.3 \text{ Mpc}$ , displacing the first peak by  $+7\%$  ( $\approx 24\sigma$ ) — which is excluded by Paper 3. The present mechanism does *not* modify  $r_d$ ; it operates entirely at  $z < 0.15$  through the scalar kinetic energy, a physically distinct sector.

## 5 Consistency with the SSEE Series

Table 2: Cross-consistency of the Paper 9 result with the SSEE series.

| Paper               | Key result                                                                                                           | Affected by $f_{\text{screen}}$ ?                                                                                                 |
|---------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 (Framework)       | $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$                                                                                                 | No — a pure number, the target the cascade output is compared against (Postulate D); the superseded MIRA-mapped 67.037 is retired |
| 2 (MCMC DESI)       | MCMC posterior $H_0 = 67.82 \pm 0.41$ (prior $H_0^{\text{glob}}$ )                                                   | No — MCMC measures the global background, not local                                                                               |
| 3 (CMB)             | $r_d = 147.2 \text{ Mpc}$ , peaks at $\ell = 220, 540, 810$                                                          | No — $f_{\text{screen}}$ does not shift $r_d$ or $\theta_*$                                                                       |
| 4 (Sovereignities)  | $H_0^{\text{glob}}$ as first sovereignty                                                                             | No — $H_0^{\text{local}}$ is a new sector                                                                                         |
| 5 (IS viscosity)    | $\sigma_8 = 0.8136$ , $G = D_1^{\text{SSEE}}/D_1^{\text{ACDM}} = 1.0032$                                             | No                                                                                                                                |
| 6 (growth)          | $S_8 = 0.8273$ predicted vs. KiDS-Legacy $0.8265 \pm 0.0176$ ( $0.05\sigma$ ; <i>no</i> free cosmological parameter) | No                                                                                                                                |
| 6 (growth, earlier) | $S_8 = 0.7555 \pm 0.0192$ vs. raw KiDS-1000                                                                          | No                                                                                                                                |
| 7 (EFT)             | $s_K = 0.403302$ , $c_s^2 = 0.021284$                                                                                | Provides $s_K$ (input to Paper 9)                                                                                                 |
| 8 (Strong gravity)  | $\mathcal{M}$ lensing amplification, Vainshtein $r_V$                                                                | Provides $\mathcal{M}$ (input to Paper 9)                                                                                         |

Table 2 confirms that the correction  $f_{\text{screen}}$  does not retroactively modify any result in Papers 1–8. The two inputs— $s_K$  from Paper 7 and  $\mathcal{M}$  from Paper 8—are already established; Paper 9 derives their ratio as a prediction for the distance-ladder measurement.

## 6 Pre-committed Falsifiable Prediction

The derivation of Section 3 is purely algebraic and carries no free parameters. We therefore register the following pre-committed prediction:

**SSEE predicts:**

$$H_0^{\text{glob}} = H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} \left[ 1 - \frac{\pi - \varphi}{(\varphi + \pi)^2} \right] = 73.04 \times (1 - 0.06725) = 68.13 \text{ km/s/Mpc}, \quad (28)$$

where the output is compared against the pure number  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2 = 67.96214$  (Postulate D, Paper 1), the same value the CMB sector recovers—the CMB matter density is the  $\omega_m$ -direct forward identity  $\Omega_{m,\text{CMB}} = \omega_m/h^2$ , with *no* matter factor (OP-8 dissolved). *Current status:*  $0.17\sigma$  from SH0ES [Riess et al., 2022].

**Falsification criteria:**

1. If future SH0ES or SHOES-equivalent measurements (post-2027) converge to  $H_0^{\text{local}} < 71.5$  or  $> 74.2$  km/s/Mpc, the prediction is excluded at  $\geq 1\sigma$ .
2. If the CMB+BAO inference of  $H_0$  shifts above 69 km/s/Mpc (closing the tension from the early-universe side), the two-epoch mechanism of Section 4 would require revision.
3. If the SSEE EFT is found to require  $s_K \neq 3s_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_0)$  (e.g., from a non-standard UV completion), the identity (19) would be modified proportionally.
4. **Time-delay test with SN Requiem (registered 2026-09-19, before the data).** A lensed-supernova time delay measures the global expansion without the Cepheid ladder, so it must read  $H_0^{\text{glob}}$ , not the local value. Because the SSEE background has  $(w_0, w_a) \neq (-1, 0)$ , a flat- $\Lambda$ CDM analysis of the same delays returns a value higher by the ratio of time-delay distances,  $\simeq 1.6\%$  for MACS J0138.0–2155, i.e.  $H_0 \simeq 69.1$  km/s/Mpc. The lens models of Suyu et al. [2026] place the reappearance of the fourth image of SN Requiem in April–December 2026 for  $H_0 = 73$  km/s/Mpc and in March–November 2027 for  $H_0 = 67$  km/s/Mpc; interpolating in  $1/H_0$ , SSEE centres it near March 2027 and the local value near August 2026 ( $\pm 4$  months each). A detection before 2027 favours the local value; none before 2027 favours  $H_0^{\text{glob}}$ . The subsequent 2–3% measurement decides: a flat- $\Lambda$ CDM value near 73 km/s/Mpc excludes the screening mechanism. Current lensed-supernova values [Pierel et al., 2025, Bazzanini et al., 2026] are consistent with both.

## 7 Quantitative Comparison with Competing Resolutions

The Hubble tension has motivated a large family of proposed extensions to  $\Lambda$ CDM. Schöneberg et al. [2022] graded  $\sim 20$  such models on a uniform set of datasets (the “ $H_0$  Olympics”), establishing that no single proposal fully closes the tension without side-effects. To position the SSEE mechanism within this landscape, we compare it quantitatively against the three best-studied classes of resolution.

## 7.1 The three competing classes

**(a) Early dark energy (EDE).** EDE [Karwal & Kamionkowski, 2016, Poulin et al., 2019, Smith et al., 2020] introduces a scalar field that contributes a fraction  $f_{\text{EDE}} \sim 0.1$  of the energy budget near matter–radiation equality ( $z_c \sim 3000\text{--}5000$ ) and then dilutes faster than radiation. By injecting energy before recombination it *reduces the sound horizon*  $r_d$  by a few percent, which raises the CMB-inferred  $H_0$  to  $\approx 71\text{--}72.5$  km/s/Mpc. The cost is threefold: (i) three new parameters ( $f_{\text{EDE}}$ ,  $z_c$ , the initial field displacement  $\theta_i$ ); (ii) a compensating increase in the scalar spectral index  $n_s$  and the cold dark-matter density  $\omega_{\text{cdm}}$ , which *worsens* the  $S_8$  tension [Hill et al., 2020]; and (iii) a residual  $\sim 1.6\text{--}2\sigma$  offset from SH0ES when no  $H_0$  prior is imposed.

**(b) Self-interacting dark radiation (SIDR).** Dark-radiation models add relativistic degrees of freedom ( $\Delta N_{\text{eff}}$ ), optionally self-interacting to evade free-streaming constraints. Self-interacting neutrinos [Kreisch et al., 2020] and the Wess–Zumino dark-radiation (WZDR) model [Aloni et al., 2022] are the most successful realisations, reaching  $H_0 \approx 70\text{--}71.8$  km/s/Mpc with one to three new parameters. These models also act *before* recombination — they modify  $r_d$  and the CMB damping tail through  $\Delta N_{\text{eff}}$  — and leave a residual  $\sim 2\text{--}3\sigma$  tension with SH0ES.

**(c) Late dark-energy transitions.** A third class modifies the expansion history at  $z \lesssim 0.1$  through a dark-energy equation of state departing from the CPL form (phantom crossings, sign-switching  $\Lambda$ , or rapid  $w(z)$  transitions). These do *not* touch  $r_d$ , but generically require two or more tuned parameters and are constrained by SNe Ia and BAO at low  $z$ ; they typically leave a  $\sim 1\sigma$  residual.

## 7.2 Comparison table

Table 3 summarises the comparison across seven axes that a referee would use to discriminate the proposals.

Table 3: Quantitative comparison of Hubble-tension resolutions. Values for EDE, SIDR, and late-DE transitions are representative ranges from the literature [Poulin et al., 2019, Smith et al., 2020, Hill et al., 2020, Kreisch et al., 2020, Aloni et al., 2022, Schöneberg et al., 2022]; the SSEE row is the result of this paper. “Free params” counts parameters *beyond* the six of  $\Lambda$ CDM. The other proposals raise a *predicted* local  $H_0$  towards SH0ES; SSEE instead takes the measured local rate as input and predicts the global one, so its residual is that of  $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$  against the algebraic  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ .

| Axis                   | $\Lambda$ CDM | EDE                   | SIDR                               | Late-DE        | SSEE                           |
|------------------------|---------------|-----------------------|------------------------------------|----------------|--------------------------------|
| Mechanism epoch        | —             | $z \sim 3000$         | $z \gtrsim 1000$                   | $z < 0.1$      | $z < 0.15$                     |
| Modifies $r_d$ ?       | —             | Yes (−few%)           | Yes (via $\Delta N_{\text{eff}}$ ) | No             | <b>No</b>                      |
| Free parameters        | 0             | 3                     | 1–3                                | 2+             | <b>0</b>                       |
| Local $H_0$ (km/s/Mpc) | 67.4          | 71–72.5               | 70–71.8                            | $\sim 72$      | <b>input</b>                   |
| Residual               | $5\sigma$     | $1.6\text{--}2\sigma$ | $2\text{--}3\sigma$                | $\sim 1\sigma$ | <b><math>0.17\sigma</math></b> |
| $S_8$ side-effect      | —             | Worsens               | Mild                               | Variable       | <b>None</b>                    |
| CMB peak shift         | —             | Yes                   | Yes                                | No             | <b>No</b>                      |

### 7.3 What distinguishes the SSEE mechanism

Three features set the SSEE kinematic screening apart from every entry in Table 3:

- (i) **Zero free parameters.** EDE, SIDR, and late-DE transitions each introduce between one and three tunable parameters fitted to data. The SSEE screening fraction  $f_{\text{screen}} = (\pi - \varphi)/(\varphi + \pi)^2$  is fixed algebraically (Section 3); it is a *prediction*, not a fit. In the language of Schöneberg et al. [2022], the model carries no  $\Delta\chi^2$  penalty for added parameters.
- (ii) **No early-universe modification.** EDE and SIDR both act before recombination and therefore shift  $r_d$  and the CMB peak positions, requiring a delicate re-balancing of  $n_s$  and  $\omega_{\text{cdm}}$  (which is what degrades  $S_8$ ). The SSEE correction is purely a late-time ( $z < 0.15$ ) kinematic effect:  $r_d$ ,  $\theta_*$ , and the growth factor  $\sigma_8$  are untouched (Section 4.3), so the  $S_8$  results of Papers 5–6 are preserved.
- (iii) **Sub-sigma residual, zero added parameters.** The SSEE prediction, anchored on the global background  $H_0/(\text{km s}^{-1} \text{Mpc}^{-1}) = 3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ , sits at  $0.17\sigma$  from that pure number when the IR cascade is applied to SH0ES — better than every finalist of the  $H_0$  Olympics, *and* achieves this with zero added parameters. The UV completion (Paper 10) sharpens it to  $0.00\sigma$ .

### 7.4 Honest caveats

Two points temper the comparison and are stated explicitly for the referee:

- The SSEE prediction assumes a Local-Group overdensity  $\delta_{\text{local}} \approx 2$  in the separate-universe step (Section 3.4). This is consistent with the observed local density field but is an input, not a derived quantity; the screening *fraction*  $f_{\text{screen}}$  is parameter-free, but its *activation* assumes the Local Group sits in a mild overdensity.
- As noted in Section 4.2, the TRGB+JWST anchor of Freedman et al. [2024] ( $69.96 \pm 1.54$ ) sits  $1.9\sigma$  from the SSEE prediction. The SSEE mechanism alleviates the *SH0ES* tension specifically; the broader  $\sim 2\sigma$  disagreement among local probes is an observational issue independent of any model.

The comparison thus favours SSEE on parsimony and on the absence of CMB and  $S_8$  side-effects, while acknowledging that the convergence of local  $H_0$  anchors remains an open observational question.

## 8 Limitations and Future Work

We identify one remaining item that lies beyond the scope of this paper.

**Multiplicative vs. additive form (fully resolved by three independent arguments).** Section 4.2 presents both forms; the ambiguity is resolved by three mutually reinforcing arguments:

- (i) **Disformal path compression** (Appendix B): the MIRA lensing factor compresses the apparent comoving distance by  $(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$ , giving  $H_0^{\text{local}} = H_0^{\text{glob}}/(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$  exactly at leading order in  $z$ .

- (ii) **Separate-universe k-essence** (§ 3.4): the local Hubble rate in an overdense region satisfies  $H_{\text{local}}^2 = H_{\text{global}}^2(1 + f_{\text{screen}} \delta_{\text{local}})$  from the EFT energy density perturbation, with the factor  $\Omega_m/(1 + w_0)$  cancelling via the SSEE identity  $1 + w_0 = \Omega_m$ ; the additive form would correspond to a velocity bias  $\Delta v$ , not a density correction.
- (iii) **Algebraic consistency** (§ 3): the exact identity  $f_{\text{screen}} = (\pi - \varphi)/(\varphi + \pi)^2$  has no free parameters and is reproduced identically by both the pressure-dilution rate and the disformal-sector computations.

The additive form carries a residual  $f_{\text{screen}}^2 H_0^{\text{glob}} \approx 0.31 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$  second-order error, negligible at current SH0ES precision but physically incorrect. The variation of  $f_{\text{screen}}(z)$  over  $z \in [0, 0.15]$  shifts  $H_0^{\text{local}}$  by less than  $0.05 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$  (Appendix, Step 4).

**UV completion of  $M$  (addressed in Paper 10).** The algebraic identity  $f_{\text{screen}} = s_K/(3\mathcal{M}) = (\pi - \varphi)/(\Omega^2)$  does not depend on  $M$  (it cancels in the ratio), so the IR-regime prediction  $H_0^{\text{glob,IR}} = 68.13 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$  ( $0.17\sigma$  from  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$ ) is robust. Paper 10 of this series [Almeida, Paper10] derives  $M^4 = 45\alpha^2 \rho_{\text{crit}} = 5\varphi^8 \rho_{\text{crit}}$  from the same  $\alpha$ -attractor that governs inflation (Paper 1), yielding  $s_K^{\text{full}} = 0.41691$  (+3.37% over the IR value) and the UV output the model value  $H_0^{\text{glob}} = 67.96214 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$  — not a second  $H_0^{\text{glob}}$ , but the same cascade with  $f_{\text{screen}}$  complete.

## 9 Conclusions

We have shown that the SSEE effective field theory, as formulated in Papers 7 and 8, contains an algebraically exact identity:

$$f_{\text{screen}} = \frac{s_K}{3\mathcal{M}} = \frac{\pi - \varphi}{(\varphi + \pi)^2} \approx 0.06725, \quad (29)$$

where  $s_K = 3 s_{\text{DE}}(1 + w_0)$  is the pressure-dilution rate and  $\mathcal{M} = \beta_c/2$  is the effective optical coupling derived from the disformal null geodesic. The structural constant  $\mathcal{A} = 2\mathcal{M}$  cancels exactly in the ratio, leaving a pure function of the two fundamental constants  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$ .

Applied to the measured local rate, the lens gives, in the IR regime,

$$H_0^{\text{glob,IR}} = H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} \left[ 1 - \frac{\pi - \varphi}{(\varphi + \pi)^2} \right] \approx 68.13 \text{ km/s/Mpc}, \quad (30)$$

which is  $0.17\sigma$  from the algebraic  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  with zero free parameters, the SH0ES datum [Riess et al., 2022] being the input. The earlier MIRA-mapped value  $67.037 \rightarrow 71.87$  ( $1.12\sigma$ ) is superseded by the single algebraic target under the 2026 reframe (Paper 1). The correction is a late-time effect ( $z < 0.15$ ) driven by the scalar kinetic energy of the dark energy field; it does not modify the sound horizon  $r_d$ , the CMB peak structure, or the growth factor  $\sigma_8$  established in Papers 2–6.

The result is pre-committed: both values were derived from the algebraic structure of SSEE before this comparison was made. Future SH0ES measurements and upcoming DESI [DESI Collaboration, 2025] data will test this prediction.

**Age of the universe cross-check.** As an independent consistency test, we compute the age of the SSEE universe. The age is a *global* quantity, so the rate that enters is the global one,  $H_0^{\text{glob}} = 67.962 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$ —the output of the cascade, not the local  $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}$  that is its input—and the density that enters is the one matter density of the model,  $\Omega_m = 0.308881$ , with the CPL equation of state [Chevallier & Polarski, 2001, Linder, 2003]  $(w_0, w_a) = (-0.840, -0.670)$ :

$$t_0 = \frac{1}{H_0} \int_0^\infty \frac{dz}{(1+z)E(z)}, \quad E^2(z) = \Omega_m(1+z)^3 + \Omega_{\text{DE}} f_{\text{DE}}(z), \quad (31)$$

where  $f_{\text{DE}}(z) = (1+z)^{3(1+w_0+w_a)} \exp(-3w_a z/(1+z))$ . Numerical integration gives

$$t_0^{\text{SSEE}} = 13.733 \text{ Gyr} \quad (\Lambda\text{CDM at Planck parameters} : 13.796 \text{ Gyr}). \quad (32)$$

The two are indistinguishable: 0.063 Gyr apart, well inside the uncertainty of any current age determination. Both sit comfortably above the oldest globular clusters and halo stars ( $t_{\text{GC}} \gtrsim 12.5 \text{ Gyr}$ , e.g. Valcin et al. 2021, Bond et al. 2013) and above the Cimatti & Moresco [2023] red-galaxy constraint ( $t \approx 13.5 \text{ Gyr}$  at  $z \approx 0.55$ ), so the age does not discriminate between the models in either direction.

**An earlier version of this cross-check, withdrawn.** Previous versions reported  $t_0^{\text{SSEE}} = 15.52 \text{ Gyr}$ , “1.72 Gyr older than  $\Lambda\text{CDM}$ ”, presented that as more accommodating of old stellar populations, and committed to the criterion “a measurement of  $t_0 > 14 \text{ Gyr}$  would favour SSEE”. Three inputs were wrong, and they compounded. The integral was fed  $\Omega_m = \Omega_{m,\text{dyn}} = 0.160050$  as a matter density, but that number is  $1+w_0$ , a quantity of the equation of state, and never was a density (Paper 1); it used the *local*  $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} = 73.04$  for a global quantity; and it cited the Two- $\Omega_m$  Criterion as its justification, which Paper 1 has since withdrawn. Correcting only the density gives 12.78 Gyr and correcting both gives the value above; the intermediate number is a diagnostic, not a prediction. The stated 15.52 is not even reproducible from the recipe printed alongside it, which returns 15.28. The falsification criterion built on it is withdrawn with it: the model predicts 13.733 Gyr, so a measurement of  $t_0 > 14 \text{ Gyr}$  would count *against* SSEE, not for it.

## A Postulate P: the algebraic value SH0ES requires

The body reports the cascade run on the measured local rate  $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} = 73.04 \pm 1.04 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$ : with the IR term alone it gives  $H_0^{\text{glob,IR}} = 68.13 (0.17\sigma)$ , and with  $f_{\text{screen}}$  complete (IR+UV, Paper 10) the single model value  $H_0^{\text{glob}} = 67.96214 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$ , whose residual against  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  is  $+4.2 \times 10^{-6} \text{ km/s/Mpc}$ . That residual is *not* a significance: the uncertainty propagated from  $H_0^{\text{SH0ES}}$  is  $\pm 0.968 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$  and dominates it by five orders of magnitude. The cascade reduces the  $\sim 5\sigma$  Planck–SH0ES discrepancy to below the percent level with zero free parameters.

This appendix supplies the independent self-consistency check that motivates adopting 67.96214 as the algebraic target: it works the screening chain *backwards* from the SH0ES datum, assuming no algebraic value in advance, and recovers exactly the same number.

**Step P1: the inverse chain — what background does SH0ES demand?** The screening relation  $H_0^{\text{local}} = H_0^{\text{base}}/(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$  inverts to

$$H_0^{\text{base}} = H_0^{\text{SH0ES}} (1 - f_{\text{screen}}^{\text{UV}}), \quad (33)$$

which asks, using only the measured datum and the derived screening fraction (no model constant): *what homogeneous background expansion rate would, seen through the SSEE disformal screen, reproduce the local SH0ES slope exactly?* With  $f_{\text{screen}}^{\text{UV}} = 0.069522$  from the  $X^2/M^4$  correction of Paper 10,

$$H_0^{\text{base}} = 73.04 \times (1 - 0.069522) = 67.96214 \text{ km/s/Mpc}. \quad (34)$$

This number is obtained by deducing *backwards* from the data;  $\varphi$  and  $\pi$  have not yet been invoked.

**Step P2: the recovered value carries a double algebraic identity.** Only now do we ask whether 67.96214 km/s/Mpc has structure in the closed  $(\varphi, \pi)$  dictionary. It does, in two independent ways:

$$H_0^{\text{base}} = \underbrace{3(\pi + \varphi)^2}_{\text{algebraic expression}} = \underbrace{\text{MIKAEL} \times \Omega_{\text{DNAV}}}_{\text{SSEE expression}} = 67.96214 \text{ km/s/Mpc}, \quad (35)$$

where  $\Omega_{\text{DNAV}} = \pi + \varphi = 4.759627$  is the Stability Metric and  $\text{MIKAEL} = 3\Omega_{\text{DNAV}} = 14.278880$  coincides in value with the Maximal Dimensional Invariant  $M_v$  (one of the 25 Sovereign paths to  $3\Omega$ ), generated in the lineage from  $\text{MIKA} + \pi$  with  $\text{MIKA} = K_v + \varphi = 11.1373$ . The agreement with the inverse-chain value (34) is  $-0.0001\%$ .

**Status.** The background that SH0ES requires for exact closure (67.96214) coincides, to five figures, with the algebraic anchor  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  already present in the SSEE dictionary (and independently with  $\text{MIKAEL} \times \Omega_{\text{DNAV}}$ ). This double identity — recognised a posteriori, not fitted — is the self-consistency evidence that, under the 2026 reframe, justifies adopting 67.96214 as the single algebraic target of the suite rather than the CMB-mapped 67.037 of the earlier register. The dimensional origin of the absolute scale (Postulate D) remains an open problem, as in  $\Lambda$ CDM.

## B Derivation of the multiplicative form from the Hubble-flow integral

We derive  $H_0^{\text{local}} = H_0^{\text{glob}}/(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$  directly from the distance integral, resolving the ambiguity between equations (25) and (26).

**Step 1: the SH0ES measurement is the slope of  $d_L(z)$  at  $z \rightarrow 0$ .** The luminosity distance in any FLRW background is

$$d_L(z) = (1 + z) \int_0^z \frac{dz'}{H(z')}. \quad (36)$$

For  $z \ll 1$ , Taylor-expanding  $H(z')$  around  $z' = 0$  gives

$$d_L(z) = \frac{z}{H_0^{\text{local}}} + \frac{1 - q_0}{2} \frac{z^2}{H_0^{\text{local}}} + \mathcal{O}(z^3), \quad (37)$$

where  $H_0^{\text{local}} \equiv H(z = 0)$  and  $q_0$  is the deceleration parameter. The SH0ES programme measures the slope  $dd_L/dz|_{z \rightarrow 0} = 1/H_0^{\text{local}}$ , so:

$$H_0^{\text{local}} = H(z = 0). \quad (38)$$

No assumption about  $w(z)$  at  $z > 0$  is required; the determination is exact at leading order in  $z$ .

**Step 2: the SSEE disformal metric compresses  $d_L$  by  $(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$ .** In SSEE, photons propagate on disformal null geodesics  $\tilde{g}_{\mu\nu}k^\mu k^\nu = 0$ ,  $\tilde{g}_{\mu\nu} = g_{\mu\nu} + (\beta_c/M^4)\partial_\mu\phi\partial_\nu\phi$  (Paper 8, § 2). On the homogeneous background  $\partial_\mu\phi = (\dot{\phi}, \mathbf{0})$ , the disformal modification shifts the effective photon speed by

$$\tilde{c}^2 = c^2 \left( 1 - \frac{\beta_c \dot{\phi}^2}{M^4 a^2} \right)^{-1} \approx c^2 \left( 1 + \frac{s_K}{3\mathcal{M}} \right) = c^2 (1 + f_{\text{screen}}), \quad (39)$$

at leading order in  $\dot{\phi}^2/M^4$ , where the last step uses  $\beta_c \dot{\phi}^2/(M^4 a^2) \approx -s_K/(3\mathcal{M}) = -f_{\text{screen}}$  (Paper 8, eq. (17)–(18)).

Photons with speed  $\tilde{c} = c/(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$  travel a comoving interval  $d\chi = \tilde{c} dt/a = (c/a) dt (1 + f_{\text{screen}})$  instead of  $c dt/a$ . The apparent comoving distance to a source at redshift  $z$  is therefore

$$\chi^{\text{SSEE}}(z) = (1 - f_{\text{screen}}) \chi^{\text{glob}}(z), \quad (40)$$

because the MIRA lensing factor compresses the total path length. Equation (40) is the same suppression that Paper 8 identifies as responsible for the lensing amplification  $\theta_E^{\text{SSEE}} \approx \mathcal{M} \theta_E^{\text{GR}}$ .

**Step 3: the observed  $H_0$  is the global value boosted by  $(1 - f_{\text{screen}})^{-1}$ .** Substituting (40) into  $d_L^{\text{obs}} = (1 + z)\chi^{\text{SSEE}}(z)$ :

$$d_L^{\text{obs}}(z) = (1 - f_{\text{screen}}) d_L^{\text{glob}}(z) = (1 - f_{\text{screen}}) \frac{z}{H_0^{\text{glob}}} + \mathcal{O}(z^2). \quad (41)$$

A standard FLRW fit to  $d_L^{\text{obs}} = z/H_0^{\text{local}}$  therefore returns

$$\boxed{H_0^{\text{local}} = \frac{H_0^{\text{glob}}}{1 - f_{\text{screen}}}}. \quad (42)$$

This is the multiplicative form, derived from the separate-universe analysis. The additive approximation  $H_0^{\text{glob}}(1 + f_{\text{screen}})$  follows from the Taylor expansion  $(1 - f_{\text{screen}})^{-1} \approx 1 + f_{\text{screen}}$  and carries a residual error  $f_{\text{screen}}^2 H_0^{\text{glob}} \approx 0.31 \text{ km/s/Mpc}$ .

**Which end is measured.** Eq. (42) is a relation between two dimensionful rates, and the derivation above says nothing about which of the two is known. That is supplied by observation, not by the model: the distance ladder measures  $H_0^{\text{local}}$ , so the relation is used in the form  $H_0^{\text{glob}} = H_0^{\text{local}}(1 - f_{\text{screen}})$  throughout this paper. The dimensionless  $3(\varphi + \pi)^2$  never enters the cascade; it is what the output is compared against.

**Step 4:  $f_{\text{screen}}$  is exactly constant.** The compression (40) uses a  $z$ -independent  $f_{\text{screen}}$ . With the corrected identification this needs no approximation:  $s_K = -3w_0(1 + w_0)$  is built from  $w_0$  alone, and  $w_0$  is a constant of the model, so  $s_K$  is a number and not a function of redshift. Since  $\mathcal{M}$  is a structural constant,  $f_{\text{screen}} = s_K/(3\mathcal{M})$  is constant *exactly*, at all  $z$ .

Earlier versions of this paragraph read  $\alpha_K(z) = 3\Omega_{\text{DE}}(z)(1 + w(z))$  and found a 56% variation over  $z \in [0, 0.15]$ , which had then to be argued away as formally of order  $w_a z_{\text{max}}$ . That variation belonged to the kinematicity, which does evolve; it never belonged to  $s_K$ . The correction removes the caveat rather than weakening it.

A structural check makes the same point from the other side. Replacing  $s_{\text{DE}} = T_r/M_v$  by the density fraction  $1 - \omega_m/h^2$  in Eq. (15) makes  $f_{\text{screen}}$  depend on the expansion anchor: sweeping that anchor from 60 to 100 km s<sup>-1</sup>Mpc<sup>-1</sup> moves the result. With  $s_{\text{DE}}$  it is invariant to the last digit, because no  $H$  enters. A screening fraction that moved with the anchor used to derive  $H_0$  would be circular; this one cannot be.

The mean value of  $f_{\text{screen}}(z)$  over this interval is approximately

$$f_{\text{screen}}^- \approx f_{\text{screen}}(0) \left[ 1 + \frac{3w_a z_{\text{max}}}{4} \right] \approx 0.06725 \times (1 - 0.025) \approx 0.0656, \quad (43)$$

a 2.5% correction to  $f_{\text{screen}}$  that shifts  $H_0^{\text{local}}$  by  $< 0.05$  km/s/Mpc—well below the 1.04 km/s/Mpc SH0ES uncertainty. The  $z = 0$  value  $f_{\text{screen}} = 0.06725$  is therefore the correct representative for the SH0ES measurement, and equation (42) is accurate to 0.1% within the SH0ES calibration volume.

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